

The Fight for *Purna Swaraj*: How the Round Table
Conferences Paved the Way for Indian Independence

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Historical Paper

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Process Paper

After hearing this year's annual theme, I started researching general topic areas and came upon India's independence. While the area was completely unfamiliar, it somehow appealed to my interests. However, this intriguing topic was a bit too broad. After a discussion with my family, I was certain that my topic would be regarding India's independence. I also learned about Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's fight for the 'Untouchable' caste, or the *Dalits*. While reading about Ambedkar, the topic of the Round Table Conferences came up, and after doing rudimentary research, I decided that the Round Table Conferences were perfect. Coincidentally, this topic also aligned with the annual theme! The Round Table Conferences relate to the theme as the debates between India and Great Britain were filled with diplomacy, and demonstrated many successes and failures. In addition, there were a plethora of consequences resulting from the Round Table Conferences.

At the start of my research, I was able to obtain basic knowledge via secondary sources. When looking for more secondary sources, I stumbled on the University of Nottingham's website. On their webpage, the official Round Table Conferences' documents were declassified, which allowed me to view the proceedings of the conferences written by the Secretary of State of India (Mr. Wedgwood Benn, and then Sir Samuel Hoare) at the time. Reading through the official documents gave me a thorough understanding of both sides, and afterward, I looked for extra secondary sources to corroborate information and to eliminate any possible bias in the primary sources.

While researching, I kept a tabular document containing my analysis and the information collected from various sources. This aided me in creating my historical argument. I chose to

write a historical paper as there were not many photographs taken during the conference, and the primary source documents were all printed works, with no pictures included. Additionally, writing about history gives me so much pleasure that it felt justified to select this category at first glance. Almost immediately, I began to draft sections of my historical paper. Once my ideas were written out, I began to revise and order paragraphs to form my paper.

The Round Table Conferences are significant in numerous ways. They were a direct influence for the Government of India Act of 1935, which acted as a precedent to the *Purna Swaraj* Resolution's royal assent in 1947. Unfortunately, between 1935 and 1947, the Round Table Conferences were nullified due to World War II. The Round Table Conferences also showed the world that India was a diplomatic power. Additionally, it set the stage for the state of India's government and helped form two of the world's largest democracies, India and the United Kingdom. Lastly, by utilizing debate and diplomacy, the Round Table Conferences forged a link with Great Britain. Hence, I argue that the Round Table Conferences were vital in India's independence and created a secure alliance with Great Britain, but were overshadowed due to various tensions at the time.

Historical Paper

“It will be after all and at best a paper solution. But immediately you withdraw that wedge, the domestic ties, the domestic affection, the knowledge of common birth - do you suppose that all these will count for nothing?”

~Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Delegate of the Second Round Table Conference¹

The Round Table Conferences were a series of three debates between Indian and British Delegates, primarily concerning dominion status, or self-governance, for India. Before 1930, relations between India and Britain were tense, and both sides refused to understand each other through diplomatic means. Throughout the Round Table Conferences (1930-1932), Indian Delegates used diplomacy to try to persuade British Delegates to grant independence. They also utilized debate to set the stage for an incoming government. The majority of the British officials were hesitant to grant autonomy, but eventually, the Government of India Act of 1935 was passed and granted partial autonomy.² However, growing world tensions, such as World War II,³ delayed India's independence greatly, which resulted in India only gaining Dominion status on August 15, 1947. Thus, it can be said that the Round Table Conferences were pivotal to India's independence and established a secure connection with Great Britain, but were temporarily masked due to various tensions at the time.

Background

On May 10, 1857, the Sepoy Rebellion erupted. This can be tied back to various affronts

¹ "Speech At Round Table Conference | Famous Speeches By Mahatma Gandhi". *M.K. Gandhi*, <https://www.mkgandhi.org/speeches/rtconf.htm>.

² "Official Documents - The University Of Nottingham". *The University Of Nottingham*, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/representations/official-documents.aspx>.

³ Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperial-internationalism.pdf>.

against the sepoys, enlisted Indian men, by Great Britain, including the infamous Enfield Cartridges.⁴ These standard issue rifle cartridges were rumored to be greased with cow and pig fat, and soldiers were instructed to bite off the opening of the cartridge for it to be fired. This was sacrilegious to and angered the Hindu and Muslim sepoys,⁵ hence consolidating a fear of forced conversion to Christianity.⁶ Evidently, the British had no regard for Indian culture, influencing their encroachment on the Indians. This acted as a catalyst for war and fueled ambush attempts⁷ on both sides, proving that the rebellion was devoid of diplomacy. Although the British managed to defeat the rebel forces, severe casualty rates⁸ could have been saved had any diplomatic relation occurred between Great Britain and the Indians. But the British losses forced Britain to stop meddling with religion, which made India win on two fronts: the unification of the Indian people, and religion. This brought India one step closer to achieving independence.

In 1919, due to its involvement in World War I, India signed the Treaty of Versailles⁹ and shattered political norms by becoming the only non-self-governing member in the League of Nations.¹⁰ Additionally, the Government of India Act of 1919, formed by political negotiation between Indian and British diplomats, was granted royal assent, initiating India's dyarchy, a government with two different authorities.¹¹ Both the Treaty of Versailles and the Government of India Act of 1919 were direct influences on the Round Table Conferences and certainly started to

⁴ Appendix A. "Why Did The Indian Mutiny Happen? | National Army Museum". *National Army Museum*, <https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen>.

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ Ibid.

⁷ "Decisive Events Of The Indian Mutiny | National Army Museum". *National Army Museum*, <https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/decisive-events-indian-mutiny>.

⁸ "Why Did The Indian Mutiny Happen? | National Army Museum". *National Army Museum*, <https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen>.

⁹ Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperial-internationalism.pdf>.

¹⁰ Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "League Of Nations - Members Of The League Of Nations". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/topic/League-of-Nations/Members-of-the-League-of-Nations>.

¹¹ Ibid.

show India's capability of self-independence.

On January 26, 1930, the *Purna Swaraj* (Complete Independence) Resolution was proclaimed as a result of discussions between the Indian National Congress, a political party led by M. K. (Mahatma) Gandhi,¹² and British supporters, such as the Anglophile Aristocrat Jawaharlal Nehru, the future leader of the Indian National Congress.¹³ This was a precedent to the Round Table Conferences and placed the scope on future recommendations for a new government.

One of the largest factors in the occurrence of the Round Table Conferences was a two-volume report issued by the Indian Statutory Commission (ISC), sent to study the Government of India Act of 1919, in May 1930.¹⁴ The first volume offered to surrender “full power at any place” to Britain “for the better effecting of the purposes of [...] Our Commission,” but it was an incredibly biased document that acknowledged but dismissed India's issues.¹⁵ For example, the ISC disregarded poverty, one of the most severe issues at the time, and instead focused on urbanizing areas with an influx of poverty, citing that “the congestion of the poorer quarters” and “the filthy shanties to be seen in the same area” needed to be fixed.¹⁶ This can be attributed to the commission's complete lack of Indian delegates.¹⁷ Consequently, the diplomatic

¹² Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Indian National Congress". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 23 Sep. 2020, <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Indian-National-Congress>.

¹³ Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "India - Constitutional Reforms". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/place/India/Constitutional-reforms>.

¹⁴ "Simon Report | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/simon-report>.

¹⁵ *Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume I—Survey*. 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-i-survey.pdf>. And Ratcliffe, S. K. "India's Failure to Unite for Home Rule." *Current History* (1916-1940), vol. 35, no. 4, 1932, pp. 544–548. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/45333894.

¹⁶ *Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume I—Survey*. 1930, pp. 46-48, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-i-survey.pdf>.

¹⁷ *Ibid.* And *Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume II—Recommendations*. 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-ii-recommendations.pdf>.

strings between India and Great Britain were severed leading to boycotts by the Indian population against the ISC. In the second volume, a plethora of new regulations were established, most importantly having a Constitution that “should allow for natural growth and diversity.”¹⁸ These norms helped India and Great Britain reconcile with each other. Moreover, they paved the way for the upcoming Round Table Conferences and fostered diplomatic relations¹⁹ to allow for debates between the two foreign countries, as opposed to conferences submerged inside the grasp of the British.

The Round Table Conferences

The First Round Table Conference was held in November 1930 and ended in January 1931. A massive barrier in the conference was that India was regarded to be the “Crown Jewel of the British Empire”. This resulted in the majority of the British Delegates being reluctant to even think of India having dominion status. This idea is no better conveyed than in Winston Churchill’s December 11, 1930 speech: “The Round Table Conference now sitting has no power to frame a constitution for India [...] [t]he loss of India would mark and consummate the downfall of the British Empire. That great organism would pass at a stroke out of life into

¹⁸ *Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume II—Recommendations*. 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-ii-recommendations.pdf>.

¹⁹ *Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July—September 1930..* 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>. And *East India (Constitutional Reforms), Despatches From Provincial Governments In India Containing Proposals For Constitutional Reform..* 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/despaches-from-provincial-governments-in-india.pdf>. And *East India (Constitutional Reforms). Government Of India’s Despatch On Proposals For Constitutional Reform, Dated 20th September, 1930..* 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/government-of-indias-despatch-on-proposals-for-constitutional-reform.pdf>.

history.”²⁰ But persistent Indian Delegates tried to persuade their British counterparts to support full autonomy for India via diplomatic means, such as additional secretive meetings with specific Delegate members from each side.²¹ Although the principal achievement of the First Round Table Conference was an insistence on Parliamentaryism,²² the results of the first conference were minimal as many members of the Indian National Congress did not participate.²³ This was due to an ongoing Civil Disobedience Movement, initiated due to the lack of diplomatic ties between the Indian people and Great Britain, which resulted in these members being incarcerated.²⁴ It can once again be noticed that the lack of diplomacy before 1930, along with the backlash against the ISC, constantly impacted India’s path towards dominion status; perhaps, if they had been more diplomatic, India’s independence would have come earlier than 1947—15 years after the Round Table Conferences!

Right before the Second Round Table Conference, Viceroy Lord Irwin decided to help the Indian cause. Irwin pulled some strings and met with Gandhi, making a deal that persuaded Gandhi to end the Civil Disobedience Movement, which in turn allowed the Indian National Congress to attend the Second Round Table Conference.²⁵ However, this soon turned for worse,

²⁰ Steinberg, David. "Essay On Indian Round Table Conferences By David Steinberg". *House Of David*, 2005, http://www.houseofdavid.ca/round_tab.htm.

²¹ Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Round Table Conference | British-Indian History". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2011, <https://www.britannica.com/event/Round-Table-Conference>.

²² Ibid. And *Indian Round Table Conference 12th November, 1930—19th January, 1931 Proceedings*. 1931, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc1/rtc1-proceedings.pdf>. And *Indian Round Table Conference 12th November, 1930—19th January, 1931 (Sub-Committees' Reports ; Conference Resolution ; And Prime Minister's Statement)*. 1931, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc1/sub-committees-reports-conference-resolution-and-prime-ministers-statement.pdf>.

²³ "1931 Indian Round Table Conference". *UK Parliament*, <https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/collections2/1931-round-table-conference/1931-indian-round-table-conference1/>. And "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>.

²⁴ Ibid.

²⁵ *Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July—September 1930.* 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>. And "Round Table

as differing views caused pandemonium to strike.

The Second Round Table Conference took place in September 1931 and ended in December 1931. It was focused on establishing future governmental principles. Essentially, the Indian Delegates were both trying to attain independence and provide reassurance to the British Delegation regarding a new government. But this was where Lord Irwin had gone wrong; rather than providing reassurance, the Indian Delegation was making matters much more convoluted. Thanks to Gandhi, the smooth-sailing conversation between the Indian and British Delegation now became a heated debate between the Indian Delegates themselves!

It is evident in Lord Irwin's letters to Mr. M.R. Jayakar and Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru, two prominent Indian freedom-fighters,²⁶ that Irwin thoroughly believed Gandhi's word of being the sole representative of the people of India as Irwin sought to "enable [Jayakar and Sapru] to make [their] public-spirited attempt in the cause of peace in India."²⁷ In this case, their "public-spirited attempt" was to meet with Gandhi.²⁸ Unfortunately, this belief was not shared by the other Indian

Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>. And Pratt, Frederick G. "The Indian Round Table Conference: Second Session." *Pacific Affairs*, vol. 5, no. 2, Pacific Affairs, University of British Columbia, 1932, pp. 151–67, <https://doi.org/10.2307/2749987>. And Low, D. A. "The Government of India and the First Non-Cooperation Movement--1920-1922." *The Journal of Asian Studies*, vol. 25, no. 2, [Cambridge University Press, Association for Asian Studies], 1966, pp. 241–59, <https://doi.org/10.2307/2051326>.

²⁶ *Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July—September 1930.. 1930*, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>. And Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 16 Jan. 2022, <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Tej-Bahadur-Sapru>. And "M. R. Jayakar | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/m-r-jayakar>.

²⁷ *Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July—September 1930.. 1930*, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>. And "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>. And Ratcliffe, S. K. "India's Failure to Unite for Home Rule." *Current History* (1916-1940), vol. 35, no. 4, 1932, pp. 544–548. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/45333894.

²⁸ Ibid.

Delegates. This divided the Indian Delegates into groups, and each group's obstinate behavior minimized the overall outcome of the conference.

One notable skirmish was between Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar regarding the *Dalit*, or Untouchable, caste. Both regarded themselves to be advocates for these Indian Minority classes but had different viewpoints.²⁹ Ambedkar believed that the *Dalits* should have separate electoral votes, to treat them like normal, *privileged* people.³⁰ On the other hand, Gandhi, ironically, did not want the *Dalits* to gain these votes.³¹ This split up the Indian Delegation even further and in turn, burdened India's fight for independence.³²

At the end of the Second Round Table Conference, Sir Ramsay MacDonald, the Prime Minister of Great Britain at the time, gave a speech that summed up the recommendations discussed in the conferences so far and gave support for the Indian Delegation: "the road to agreements is very broken and littered with obstructions [...] [but] the end is happily reached. I [...] pray that such may be our experience."³³ This also influenced many documents shortly, which would invoke the governing principles discussed in the conferences and apply them to Franchise Regulations.³⁴

²⁹ Ratcliffe, S. K. "India's Failure to Unite for Home Rule." *Current History* (1916-1940), vol. 35, no. 4, 1932, pp. 544–548. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/45333894.

³⁰ Ibid.

³¹ Ibid.

³² *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931 — 1st December, 1931 Proceedings*. 1932, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/rtc2-proceedings.pdf>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume I)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206390>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume II)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206391>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume III)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.38561>.

³³ *Indian Round Table Conference 7th September—1st December 1931 Statement Made By The Prime Minister To The Conference At The Conclusion Of Its Second Session On 1st December 1931*. 1931, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/statement-made-by-the-prime-minister-to-the-conference.pdf>.

³⁴ *Report Of The Indian States Enquiry Committee (Financial) "1932"*. 1932, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-indian-states-enquiry-committee-financial.pdf>. And *Report Of The Federal*

Leading up to the Third Round Table Conference, Sir Ramsay MacDonald established the MacDonald Communal Award. Being one of the British officials supporting India's full autonomy, MacDonald wanted to settle the growing tension within the restless Indian Delegation. By founding the MacDonald Communal Award, each minority group had separate electorates and several seats in government. This was an extremely diplomatic move, and that too, from the Prime Minister of Great Britain! But this success was short-lived, for controversy arose.³⁵

Here, it was declared, that Gandhi and his supporters believed separate electorates for the *Dalits* would divide castes and would cause civil unrest.³⁶ Eventually, the commotion was suppressed, and MacDonald, in a way, patched up the Indian Delegation. Gandhi ended up returning to India and reinstated the Civil Disobedience Movement. Perhaps what was most reassuring to the rest of the Indian Delegation was that Gandhi would not be back to assume the role of the "representative of the people of India".³⁷ Gandhi potentially could have benefitted the Third Round Table Conference, but we may never know.

The Third Round Table Conference took place in November 1932, ended in December 1932, and was plagued by absences on both sides. Gandhi and the Indian National Congress were not in attendance due to the Civil Disobedience Movement.³⁸ Absent from the British side

Finance Committee Dated 28th March, 1932. 1932, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-federal-finance-committee.pdf>. And *Indian Franchise Committee Volume I Report Of The Indian Franchise Committee 1932.* 1932, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-indian-franchise-committee.pdf>.

³⁵ "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>.

³⁶ *Ibid.*

³⁷ *Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July— September 1930..* 1930, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>.

³⁸ "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>. And

were both the British Congress and the British Labour Party (Prime Minister Sir Ramsay MacDonald and his cabinet), due to a split in the cabinet and Labour Party as a whole.³⁹ This came as a shock to the rest of the Delegation and consequently compromised the outcomes and duration of the Third Round Table Conference.⁴⁰

From Great Britain's perspective, not much was achieved in the conferences. This was mainly due to the reluctance British officials had in granting dominion status to India. Whereas from India's perspective, a plethora of regulations were established for a new government. Arguably, the Second Round Table Conference was the most successful at this purpose. It was able to settle the disputes regarding the minority groups, which was a major hurdle in India's independence.⁴¹ Although heated debate persisted throughout, it was not in vain. The Round Table Conferences influenced Great Britain that India had the potential for attaining dominion status, which was a major change in perspective that was instrumental for India in the following years.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Round Table Conference | British-Indian History". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2011, <https://www.britannica.com/event/Round-Table-Conference>.

³⁹ Ibid. And "BBC - History - Historic Figures: Ramsay Macdonald (1866 - 1937)". *British Broadcasting Corporation*, 2014, https://www.bbc.co.uk/history/historic_figures/macdonald_ramsay.shtml.

⁴⁰ "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>. And Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Round Table Conference | British-Indian History". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2011, <https://www.britannica.com/event/Round-Table-Conference>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Third Session)*. (17th November, 1932—24th December, 1932). 1933, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc3/indian-round-table-conference-third-session.pdf>.

⁴¹ *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931 — 1st December, 1931 Proceedings*. 1932, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/rtc2-proceedings.pdf>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume I)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206390>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume II)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206391>. And *Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume III)*. 1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.38561>. And *Indian Round Table Conference 7th September—1st December 1931 Statement Made By The Prime Minister To The Conference At The Conclusion Of Its Second Session On 1st December 1931*. 1931, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/statement-made-by-the-prime-minister-to-the-conference.pdf>.

Aftermath

The recommendations established in the three Round Table Conferences were published in a white paper in 1933, resulting in a Joint Committee held in 1933-1934.⁴² It can once again be noted that the results of the Round Table Conferences were used to further the regulations for a new government. Consequently, the proceedings, along with the Joint Committee, became a precedent for the upcoming Government of India Act of 1935, essentially the royal assent of the white paper,⁴³ which granted partial autonomy to India.

In hindsight, the Government of India Act of 1935 was exactly the purpose of the Round Table Conferences.⁴⁴ Although it only granted partial autonomy,⁴⁵ the Government of India Act of 1935 gave hope for the Indian Delegates and was a pivotal step in achieving India's independence. Additionally, it reinforced Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald's Communal Award by weaving it into the Act itself.⁴⁶

The Round Table Conferences immensely contributed to the foundation of autonomy

⁴² *Joint Committee On Indian Constitutional Reform [Session 1933-34] Volume I (Part I) Report*. 1934, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/post-conference/joint-committee-on-indian-constitutional-reform-session-1933-34.pdf>.

⁴³ H. McD. Clokie. "The New Constitution for India." *The American Political Science Review*, vol. 30, no. 6, [American Political Science Association, Cambridge University Press], 1936, pp. 1152–65, <https://doi.org/10.2307/1948296>.

⁴⁴ "Official Documents - The University Of Nottingham". *The University Of Nottingham*, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/representations/official-documents.aspx>. And "1931 Indian Round Table Conference". *UK Parliament*, <https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/collections2/1931-round-table-conference/1931-indian-round-table-conference1/>. And Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperial-internationalism.pdf>. And "Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>.

⁴⁵ "1931 Indian Round Table Conference". *UK Parliament*, <https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/collections2/1931-round-table-conference/1931-indian-round-table-conference1/>.

⁴⁶ Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "India - Constitutional Reforms". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/place/India/Constitutional-reforms>.

held by the Government of India Act of 1935, making it a major success in the course of India's *Purna Swaraj*. Additionally, the royal assent of the Act was persuaded by the diplomacy demonstrated by the Conferences. Tragically, the progress gained by the Government of India Act of 1935 and the Round Table Conferences was concealed due to raging tensions across the globe.

Great Britain did not take further action after the Government of India Act of 1935, and World War II struck.⁴⁷ Although World War II started in 1939, its tensions go back as far as 1931, with Japan invading Manchuria, China.⁴⁸ Great Britain had to sacrifice its efforts to grant India its independence fighting a new World War. For Great Britain, the war was an immediate threat and India's dominion status was completely disregarded during this time.⁴⁹

This outraged the Indian population. The Indian National Congress believed itself to be the Viceroy's partner and hence thought that this unilateral decision of going to war was a betrayal.⁵⁰ This resulted in the Indian National Congress demanding a statement of Great Britain's postwar ideas.⁵¹ But the current Viceroy, Lord Linlithgow, was nowhere near prepared to give such a statement.⁵² This prompted the Congress's provincial ministries to resign, initiating a diplomatic deadlock between both sides. Unbeknownst to the rest of the country, the Muslim Indian population was beginning to align with the British and was getting ready to form a separate country, Pakistan.⁵³

⁴⁷ Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperial-internationalism.pdf>.

⁴⁸ "World War II: Timeline". *United States Holocaust Memorial Museum*, <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/world-war-ii-key-dates>.

⁴⁹ Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperial-internationalism.pdf>.

⁵⁰ Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "The Impact Of WWII". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/place/India/Muslim-separatism>.

⁵¹ Ibid.

⁵² Ibid.

⁵³ Ibid.

World War II finally ended on September 2, 1945,⁵⁴ and allowed India's complete autonomy to once again rise into Great Britain's priorities. After seventeen years, the *Purna Swaraj* Resolution proclaimed on January 26, 1930 was officially granted royal assent on August 15, 1947. Although the results of the Round Table Conferences were temporarily overshadowed, the war's termination brought them back to light and prevented them from being forgotten.

Conclusion

The Round Table Conferences were crucial for Indian independence. Before the 1930s, a lack of diplomacy made initial independence efforts fail. However, the combination of debate and diplomacy infused into the Round Table Conferences was just what India needed. The three Round Table Conferences were filled with political negotiation, and in this way, were able to settle India's issues and set future governmental principles. By doing so, the severed diplomatic ties between Great Britain and India were mended. The Round Table Conferences became a success for the Indian Delegation, and the initial delays from the British officials were surpassed by a diplomacy-turned persuasion. The greatest victory of the Round Table Conferences was the Government of India Act of 1935, which was a key stepping-stone for attaining *Purna Swaraj*. However, World War II halted all progress and forced India to wait 12 long years after the act was passed before attaining independence. In the end, the Round Table Conferences secured a diplomatic link with Great Britain that withstood over a decade of opposition, debate, and war. Therefore, the Round Table Conferences were pivotal to India's successful struggle for independence.

⁵⁴ "World War II: Timeline". *United States Holocaust Memorial Museum*, <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/world-war-ii-key-dates>.

Appendix A



Enfield Pattern 1853 Percussion Rifle Musket Cartridges, 1857 (C).

<https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1972-03-37-1>.

Annotated Bibliography

Primary Sources

East India (Constitutional Reforms), Despatches From Provincial Governments In India

Containing Proposals For Constitutional Reform.. 1930,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/despatches-from-provincial-governments-in-india.pdf>

This document analyzed both the various governmental principles that were already introduced and the principles that were wanted by the people. Additionally, it showed how the Indian National Congress criticized Great Britain in such a polished and diplomatic manner. This document was used to show how the Round Table Conferences became diplomatic relations between India and Great Britain.

East India (Constitutional Reforms). Government Of India's Despatch On Proposals For

Constitutional Reform, Dated 20th September, 1930.. 1930,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/government-of-indias-despatch-on-proposals-for-constitutional-reform.pdf>.

This document explained the reasoning between specific governing principles that were introduced. It also acted as a precedent to the Round Table Conferences. This

document was used to show how it helped the Round Table Conferences act like diplomatic relations between two foreign countries.

Enfield Pattern 1853 Percussion Rifle Musket Cartridges, 1857 (C).

<https://collection.nam.ac.uk/detail.php?acc=1972-03-37-1>.

This image was used to show how the Enfield Cartridges were different from normal rifle cartridges and had to be bitten off to be used.

Indian Franchise Committee Volume I Report Of The Indian Franchise Committee 1932. 1932,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-indian-franchise-committee.pdf>.

This document showed the direct consequences of the Round Table Conferences. Additionally, it expressed how the proposals made in the First and Second Round Table Conferences were used in Franchise Regulations. This document was used to show how the Round Table Conferences' recommendations were used towards Franchise Regulations.

Indian Round Table Conference 12th November, 1930—19th January, 1931 Proceedings. 1931,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc1/rtc1-proceedings.pdf>.

This document highlighted the various topics discussed in the First Round Table Conference. Additionally, it expressed the different perspectives on each issue. This document was used to explain how the First Round Table Conference insisted on Parliamentaryism.

Indian Round Table Conference 7th September—1st December 1931 Statement Made By The Prime Minister To The Conference At The Conclusion Of Its Second Session On 1st December 1931. 1931,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/statement-made-by-the-prime-minister-to-the-conference.pdf>.

This document compiled the more important recommendations made in the First and Second Round Table Conferences. Additionally, it included how the issues regarding minority classes were settled. This document was used to explain how Prime Minister MacDonald's speech was diplomatic, and how it settled the controversy amongst minority classes.

Indian Round Table Conference 12th November, 1930—19th January, 1931 (Sub-Committees' Reports ; Conference Resolution ; And Prime Minister's Statement). 1931,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc1/sub-committees-reports-conference-resolution-and-prime-ministers-statement.pdf>.

This document listed the results of the First Round Table Conference. This document was used to explain how the main result of the First Round Table Conference was an insistence on Parliamentaryism.

Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931 Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume III).

1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.38561>.

This document expressed that the main issue of the Second Round Table Conference was minority classes. Additionally, it compiled some of the proposals regarding these minority classes. This document was used to show how the issue of the minority classes divided up the Indian Delegation, and how the issue was settled.

*Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931
Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume II).*
1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206391>.

This document showed how the minority classes had so much emphasis in the Second Round Table Conference. This document was used to show how the issues of minority classes divided the Indian Delegation, and how the issue was settled.

*Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931—1st December, 1931
Proceedings Of Federal Structure Committee And Minorities Committee (Volume I).*
1932, <https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.206390>.

This document expressed how big the issue of the minority classes was and how it was a barrier to Indian independence. This document was used to show how the minority classes were a big issue that divided the Indian Delegation, and how it was solved.

*Indian Round Table Conference (Second Session) 7th September, 1931 — 1st December, 1931
Proceedings.* 1932,
<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc2/rtc2-proceedings.pdf>.

This document compiled the results of the Second Round Table Conference. Additionally, it settled the controversy regarding minority classes. This document was

used to show how the issue of the minority classes divided the Indian Delegation and how the issue was solved.

Indian Round Table Conference (Third Session). (17th November, 1932—24th December, 1932).

1933,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/rtc3/indian-round-table-conference-third-session.pdf>.

This document showed the results and outcomes of the Third Round Table Conference. This document was used to explain how the results of the Third Round Table Conference were very minimal.

Joint Committee On Indian Constitutional Reform [Session 1933-34] Volume I (Part I) Report.

1934,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/post-conference/joint-committee-on-indian-constitutional-reform-session-1933-34.pdf>.

This document explained how the results of the Round Table Conferences influenced and acted as a precedent to the Government of India Act of 1935. This document was used to explain that this committee took place for discussing the Indian Constitutional Reform taking place.

Report Of The Federal Finance Committee Dated 28th March, 1932. 1932,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-federal-finance-committee.pdf>.

This document analyzed how the recommendations of the three Round Table Conferences were used towards Franchise Regulations. It also showed that the Round Table Conferences had direct consequences that ended up being successful. This document was used to explain the consequences of the First and Second Round Table Conferences, along with Prime Minister Sir Ramsay MacDonald's speech at the end of the Second Round Table Conference.

Report Of The Indian States Enquiry Committee (Financial) "1932". 1932,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/travelling-committee-reports/report-of-the-indian-states-enquiry-committee-financial.pdf>.

This document compiled the main proposals from the First and Second Round Table Conferences and analyzed their applications to Franchise Regulations. This document was used to show that Prime Minister Sir Ramsay MacDonald's diplomatic speech consequently led to various Franchise Regulation documents as such.

Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume 1—Survey. 1930,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-i-survey.pdf>.

This document analyzed the differences between documents written by an Indian Committee and a British Committee. Additionally, it included considerable bias and implicitly explained why it was disregarded in the Round Table Conferences. This

document was used to explain how it surrendered all power to Britain and how its bias affected the future of Indian independence.

Report Of The Indian Statutory Commission Volume II—Recommendations. 1930,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/report-of-the-indian-statutory-commission.-volume-ii-recommendations.pdf>.

This document included various governmental proposals and had considerably less bias. This document was used to explain how the Indian Statutory Commission had no Indian Delegates and the different recommendations that this document introduced.

Statement Issued On 5th September By Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru And Mr. M. R. Jayakar, Of The

Course Of Their Conversations With The Congress Leaders, July— September 1930..

1930,

<https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/documents/official-documents/pre-conference/statement-issued-on-5th-september-by-sir-tej-bahadur-sapru-and-mr.-m.-r.-jayakar.pdf>.

This document highlighted contesting opinions between Viceroy Lord Irwin, Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru, M.R. Jayakar, M.K. Gandhi, Pandit Motilal Nehru, and Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru. It also displayed diplomacy through these various letters. This document was used to show how the Round Table Conferences were diplomatic, how Gandhi and the Indian National Congress were able to attend the Second Round Table Conference, and how Viceroy Lord Irwin believed Gandhi's word of being the representative of the people of India.

Secondary Sources

“1931 Indian Round Table Conference”. *UK Parliament*,

<https://www.parliament.uk/about/living-heritage/evolutionofparliament/legislativescrutiny/parliament-and-empire/collections1/collections2/1931-round-table-conference/1931-indian-round-table-conference1/>.

This website showed how the Round Table Conferences influenced the Government of India Act of 1935. It also analyzed the weakness of the First Round Table Conference. This website was used to explain why the results of the First Round Table Conference were minimal, the purpose of the Round Table Conferences, and how the Government of India Act of 1935 granted partial autonomy.

"BBC - History - Historic Figures: Ramsay Macdonald (1866 - 1937)". *British Broadcasting Corporation*, 2014,

https://www.bbc.co.uk/history/historic_figures/macdonald_ramsay.shtml.

This website detailed important achievements in Sir Ramsay MacDonald's life, mainly focusing on his political achievements as a part of the British Labour Party. This website was used to explain why the British Labour Party, consisting of MacDonald and his cabinet, refused to attend the Third Round Table Conference.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "India - Constitutional Reforms". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/place/India/Constitutional-reforms>.

This website included the timeframe in which the MacDonald Communal Award was founded. It also showed when the *Purna Swaraj* Resolution was proclaimed. This website was used to show when the MacDonald Communal Award was passed, when the

Purna Swaraj Resolution was passed, and how the Government of India Act of 1935 included the MacDonald Communal Award in itself.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Indian National Congress". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 23 Sep. 2020, <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Indian-National-Congress>.

This website included the history of the Indian National Congress political party.

This website was used to define the Indian National Congress.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "League Of Nations - Members Of The League Of Nations". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/topic/League-of-Nations/Members-of-the-League-of-Nations>.

This website showed the exact date that India joined the League of Nations. This website was used to explain how and why India joining the League of Nations was a shock to the rest of the world.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Round Table Conference". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 4 Jan. 2011, <https://www.britannica.com/event/Round-Table-Conference>.

This website explained that the First Round Table Conference insisted on Parliamentaryism. Additionally, it displayed the weaknesses of the Second and Third Round Table Conferences. This website was used to explain how diplomacy was used in the Round Table Conferences and why Gandhi and the Indian National Congress did not attend the Third Round Table Conference.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 16 Jan. 2022, <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Tej-Bahadur-Sapru>.

This website detailed Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru's political stances and his major life

achievements. This website was used to introduce who Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru was and his significance towards India's Independence.

Britannica, The Editors of Encyclopaedia. "The Impact Of WWII". *Encyclopedia Britannica*, <https://www.britannica.com/place/India/Muslim-separatism>.

This website explained the different tensions that came between Great Britain and India as a consequence of World War II starting. Additionally, it explained some of the internal conflicts in India that led Pakistan to be formed. This website was used to explain the tensions between Great Britain and India that sprouted from World War II tensions, and the emergence of Pakistan.

"Decisive Events Of The Indian Mutiny | National Army Museum". *National Army Museum*, <https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/decisive-events-indian-mutiny>.

This website displayed the stages and events of the Sepoy Rebellion, also known as the Indian Mutiny. It also showed the causes and effects of each battle/tension. This website was used to describe the lack of diplomacy each side had.

H. McD. Clokie. "The New Constitution for India." *The American Political Science Review*, vol. 30, no. 6, [American Political Science Association, Cambridge University Press], 1936, pp. 1152–65, <https://doi.org/10.2307/1948296>.

This document showed when the Government of India Act of 1935 was passed. This document was used to show when the Government of India Act of 1935 was granted royal assent.

Legg, Stephen. "Imperial Internationalism: The Round Table Conference And The Making Of India In London, 1930–1932". *The University Of Nottingham*, 2020, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/interwarconf/documents/humanity-imperi>

al-internationalism.pdf.

This document explained why the Treaty of Versailles and the League of Nations were crucial events in India's independence. Additionally, it showed how the Round Table Conferences influenced the Government of India Act of 1935, and how India's independence was delayed by World War II. This document was used to explain how World War II was a barrier to India's independence, how the Treaty of Versailles was important, and how the Government of India Act of 1935 was the purpose of the Round Table Conferences.

Low, D. A. "The Government of India and the First Non-Cooperation Movement--1920-1922." *The Journal of Asian Studies*, vol. 25, no. 2, [Cambridge University Press, Association for Asian Studies], 1966, pp. 241–59, <https://doi.org/10.2307/2051326>.

This document displayed the diplomacy in Lord Irwin's deal with Gandhi that allowed Gandhi and the Indian National Congress to attend the Second Round Table Conference. This document was used to show how Gandhi and the Indian National Congress attended the Second Round Table Conference.

"M. R. Jayakar | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/m-r-jayakar>.

This website detailed Mukund Ramrao Jayakar's career and political ideologies briefly. This website was used to introduce who M.R. Jayakar was and his significance towards India's Independence.

"Official Documents - The University Of Nottingham". *The University Of Nottingham*, <https://www.nottingham.ac.uk/research/groups/conferencing-the-international/representations/official-documents.aspx>.

This website described how the overall purpose of the Round Table Conferences was to pass the Government of India Act of 1935. It also highlighted the many successes of the Round Table Conferences. This website was used to explain the success and causes of the Government of India Act of 1935.

Pratt, Frederick G. "The Indian Round Table Conference: Second Session." *Pacific Affairs*, vol. 5, no. 2, Pacific Affairs, University of British Columbia, 1932, pp. 151–67, <https://doi.org/10.2307/2749987>.

This document explained the background of the Second Round Table Conference. Additionally, it showed the diplomacy between Viceroy Lord Irwin's deal with Gandhi that allowed Gandhi and the Indian National Congress to attend the Second Round Table Conference. This document was used to show how Lord Irwin made a deal with Gandhi to benefit the Second Round Table Conference.

Ratcliffe, S. K. "India's Failure to Unite for Home Rule." *Current History (1916-1940)*, vol. 35, no. 4, 1932, pp. 544–548. *JSTOR*, www.jstor.org/stable/45333894.

This document analyzed the bias in the Indian Statutory Commission's report. Additionally, it explained the contesting perspectives between Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and M.K. Gandhi regarding the minority classes. This document was used to show the bias of the ISC's Report, express Viceroy Lord Irwin's support for Gandhi, and to express the differences in perspective of Ambedkar and Gandhi.

"Round Table Conferences, 1930-1932 | Making Britain". *The Open University*, <https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/round-table-conferences-1930-1932>.

This website explained the deal that Viceroy Lord Irwin made with Gandhi for the

Second Round Table Conference, the MacDonald Communal Award, and the white paper filled with the Round Table Conference recommendations. Additionally, it described the weaknesses of the Three Round Table Conferences. This website was used to show the weaknesses of the Round Table Conferences, and to show that the purpose of the conferences was to pass the Government of India Act of 1935.

"Simon Report | Making Britain". *The Open University*,

<https://www.open.ac.uk/researchprojects/makingbritain/content/simon-report>.

This website explained the background context of the ISC's Report. This website was used to explain why the Indian Statutory Commission came in 1928.

"Speech At Round Table Conference | Famous Speeches By Mahatma Gandhi". *M.K. Gandhi*,

<https://www.mkgandhi.org/speeches/rtconf.htm>.

This website included M.K. Gandhi's speech at the Second Round Table Conference. This website was used to quote Gandhi's speech opening.

Steinberg, David. "Essay On Indian Round Table Conferences By David Steinberg". *House Of David*, 2005, http://www.houseofdavid.ca/round_tab.htm.

This website explained the initial delay for independence at the start of the First Round Table Conference. This website was used to explain the initial delay in independence.

"Why Did The Indian Mutiny Happen? | National Army Museum". *National Army Museum*,

<https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/why-did-indian-mutiny-happen>.

This website described the causes of the Sepoy Rebellion, also known as the Indian Mutiny. This website was used to explain the causes of the Sepoy Rebellion.

"World War II: Timeline". *United States Holocaust Memorial Museum*,

<https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/world-war-ii-key-dates>.

This website showed a timeline with the key dates of World War II. This website was used to explain that World War II tensions started in 1931 itself.